realises that it has reached the end of the disc.

Your recording software does not include the area reserved for the lead-out when it tells you the capacity of the disk. Thus data can be burnt on the reserved area, and possibly into a few blocks past the end of it. This is referred to as 'over-burning' a disc. Overburning again would depend on factors such as the CD-R disk and the writer unit. If a writer isn't able to overburn, it will usually reject the cue sheet before writing begins.

To overburn a CD you need to use software that will not refuse to exceed the disc capacity. For example, CDRWIN warns you that the write may fail, but will allow you to continue anyway. Nero offers the option, under Expert Features, called 'Enable oversize disc', which allows for longer write.

Be warned that overburning can cause write errors. Depending on the disc and your player, the disc surface past the end of the area reserved for the lead-out may be unreliable and you may have trouble seeking out your tracks near the end of the disc.

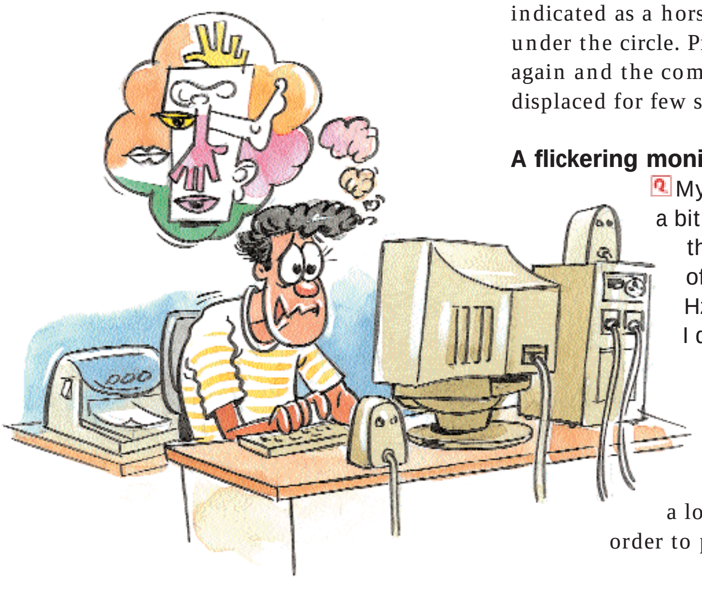
RAM

System does not detect new RAM module

I recently installed a new RAM module but my system refuses to detect it. What could be the problem?

There are two reasons for such an incident to occur. The newly installed memory module may not have been correctly placed in the memory bank in the first case. In such a situation, the computer will report a relevant error message in the form of a beep. To fix this you will have to open the computer and reinsert the RAM in a different slot.

However, on restarting, if the RAM is still not detected, chances are that the RAM might be defective. Try using the same RAM on your friend's machine and if the result is still the same, then you should ask your dealer to replace it with a new RAM module.



Installing different RAM modules

I have a motherboard that supports PC 133 MHz RAM. However, one of the RAM modules is PC 133 MHz and the other is PC 100 MHz RAM. Can I install them together and will it work fine?

If your CPU is running at 133 MHz then by default both your RAM modules will be forced to run at 133 MHz inspite of one being a 100 MHz module. Now whether the latter can take the extra load depends on its type and quality.

MONITORS

A distorted display

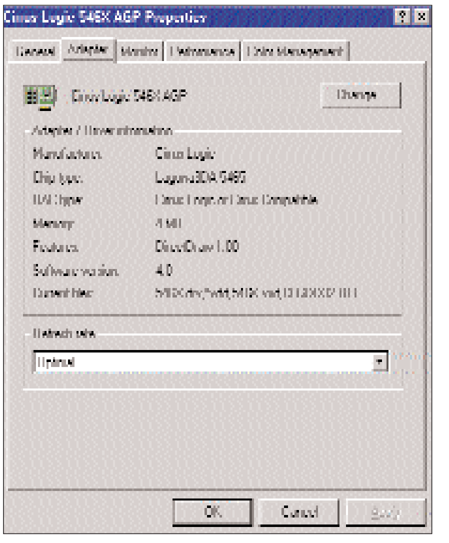
My monitor looks slightly distorted or appears in a single-edge colour. How do I fix it?

If your screen has developed scattered spots of discolouration then you will have to make use of the degauss function which will cleanse the build up of stray magnetic fields on your monitor. To degauss your monitor, press the menu button on your monitor and get to the degauss function, which is indicated as a horseshoe magnet crossed under the circle. Press the menu button again and the complete screen will get displaced for few seconds.

A flickering monitor

My monitor flickers quite a bit when I try to increase the refresh rate (it only offers a setting of 60 Hz). What can I do?

There is nothing wrong with your monitor. The flickering is caused due to a low refresh rate. In order to prevent the flickering, your monitor should be set at a refresh rate of at least 75 Hz. You will be able to adjust the refresh rate depending upon



Select the right resolution for a flicker-free display

the limitation of the monitor and the graphics card. Sometimes, when Windows does not find the right monitor drivers, it installs the default monitor drivers because of which you may not be able to push further a particular refresh rate. Therefore, first try and install the right drivers for your monitor and see whether you can increase the refresh rate. If you still can't, then try running at a lower resolution.

SPEAKERS

A sound problem in XP

I have a system running on Pentium III 700 MHz with 256 MB SDRAM on an ASUS CUSL2 motherboard. My graphics card is a GeForce-2 MX400 with 32 MB RAM. I have a four-channel soundcard based on the CMI8378 chipset and a 4.1 speaker system. I am running Windows 98 SE. All was fine until recently when I upgraded to Windows XP Professional. Now the rear channels of my speakers fail to give any output when I am running XP but when I switch back to Windows 98 SE, they work fine. What could be the problem?

The drivers that you are using are meant for Windows 98 and not Windows XP and as a result you are facing this problem.

You can download the appropriate drivers for the CMI chipset from ***www.pcdrivers.com***.